Pre-analysis plan

August 2025

Hypotheses being tested in the study

H1. Having daughters leads to stronger support for gender equality (as measured by attitudes).

H2. Having daughters leads to more left-leaning political preferences.

H3. Having daughters leads to more gender equality in the household (as measured by behaviors or outcomes).

H4. Having daughters leads to a larger increase in the support of gender equality for men than for women (with gender equality measured by attitudes).

Variables

H1. The main independent variable is *d_daughter*, a dummy variable to determine whether the participant has at least one daughter (1) or not (0). The variable is constructed based on the variables "kidsex01" to "kidsex19". The outcome variable is $plh0308_v2$. The original code is as follows: from 1 completely disagree to 7 completely agree (keep as is for the analysis). Values -1, -8, -5 are recoded as missing.

H2. The main independent variable is *d_daughter*, a dummy variable to determine whether the participant has at least one daughter (1) or not (0). The variable is constructed based on the variables "kidsex01" to "kidsex19". The outcome variable is plh0004, a left-right scale, running from 0 (left) to 10 (right). Values -1, -8, -5 are recoded as missing.

H3. The main independent variable is *d_daughter*, a dummy variable to determine whether the participant has at least one daughter (1) or not (0). The variable is constructed based on the variables "kidsex01" to "kidsex19". The dependent variable is constructed using individual-level data on weekly childcare hours (child_care_hours, variable name *pli0044_h* in the SOEP) and gender (man, where 1=man, 0=woman). First, we calculate the overall population mean of childcare hours across all respondents,

i.e, the "equal share" benchmark. The equality measure is then defined as: For men: equality_measure = child_care_hours - equal_share, and For women: equality_measure = equal_share - child_care_hours.

H4. The main independent variable is *d_daughter*, a dummy variable to determine whether the participant has at least one daughter (1) or not (0). The variable is constructed based on the variables "kidsex01" to "kidsex19". The outcome variable is $plh0308_v2$. The original code is as follows: from 1 completely disagree to 7 completely agree (keep as is for the analysis). Values -1, -8, -5 are recoded as missing. The moderator is the variable "sex" (not recoded).

Inclusion/exclusion criteria

Keep only people with completed interviews

Keep only participants from private households

Exact analysis

H1. OLS regression, with robust standard errors. Controls: gebjahr years_educ sex income occup_position. Dependent variable: *gender_equality* ; Independent variable: *d_daughter*

H2. OLS regression, with robust standard errors. Controls: gebjahr years_educ sex income occup_position. Dependent variable: ideology.

H3. OLS regression, with robust standard errors. Controls: gebjahr years_educ income occup_position and number of children. Dependent variable: equality_measure.

H4. OLS regression, with robust standard errors. Controls: gebjahr years_educ income occup_position. Dependent variable: *gender_equality* ; Independent variable: *d_daughter*. Moderator: variable *sex*.

Interpretation of results

H1. I will characterize the effect as being statistically significant if the p-value is below $\alpha = 0.05$. The result will be in line with the hypothesis if the coefficient is **positive**.

H2. I will characterize the effect as being statistically significant if the p-value is below $\alpha = 0.05$. The result will be in line with the hypothesis if the coefficient is **negative**

H3. I will characterize the effect as being statistically significant if the p-value is below $\alpha = 0.05$. The result will be in line with the hypothesis if the coefficient is **positive**.

H4. I will characterize the effect as being statistically significant if the p-value is below $\alpha = 0.05$. The result will be in line with the hypothesis if the coefficient is **positive**.